

Peak 11 Media

Recurring Management & Retention SOP — The \$49/mo Care Plan

How a one-time \$900–\$1,200 build becomes recurring, near-passive monthly revenue — and how to keep clients paying happily for years. Updated June 2026.

1. Why the Care Plan Is the Real Business

A website build is a one-time payday. The **Care Plan is the asset**. Every client who stays on the \$49/mo plan turns a single sale into a stream that compounds month after month with almost no new effort. Builds pay the bills today; the Care Plan base is what makes Peak 11 a real, sellable, near-passive business.

The math is the point:

Clients on Care Plan	Monthly recurring (MRR)	Annual recurring (ARR)
10	\$490/mo	\$5,880/yr
25	\$1,225/mo	\$14,700/yr
50	\$2,450/mo	\$29,400/yr
100	\$4,900/mo	\$58,800/yr
200	\$9,800/mo	\$117,600/yr

100 clients x \$49 = \$4,900/mo — for a few hours of work a week.

Because the system below is built on templated edits, AI-executed changes, and free monitoring, the management load barely rises as the client count climbs. That gap — flat effort, rising revenue — is exactly what makes the Care Plan passive income instead of a job.

2. What the \$49/mo Buys (and What It Doesn't)

The plan must be generous enough to feel like a no-brainer and tight enough that it never becomes a free redesign service. Draw the line clearly on day one and the plan stays profitable.

Included in the \$49/mo Care Plan

Service	What the client gets
Hosting & domain management	Site stays live, fast, and SSL-secured. We keep the hosting (Vercel/Netlify) and domain renewal handled. No separate hosting bill to think about.
Unlimited reasonable content edits	Text changes, swapping photos, updating hours, prices, menu items, services, staff, seasonal banners, contact info, adding a testimonial. The everyday upkeep of a real business website.
Uptime monitoring	Their site is checked automatically around the clock. If it goes down, we know before they do and fix it.
Security & software updates	Dependencies, plugins, SSL certs, and the platform kept patched and current so the site stays secure and doesn't break.

Service	What the client gets
Support, 1 business day	Email/text a dedicated address; a real human-quality reply and action within one business day. Most edits same day.
Peace of mind	One number to call when anything about their website needs attention. They never touch code, hosting, or a dashboard.

NOT included — quoted separately

- **Redesigns** — a new look, new branding, or rebuilding the site from scratch. (Quoted as a project.)
- **New pages** — adding whole new sections/pages beyond what was built (e.g., a new "Services" or "Gallery" page, a blog). Quoted per page.
- **New features / functionality** — booking systems, online ordering, e-commerce, membership logins, custom forms, integrations. Quoted per feature.
- **Content creation** — writing long-form copy from scratch, photo/video shoots, or logo design. (Edits to existing content are included; creating new content is a service.)

The line that keeps the plan profitable: "edit" vs "build."

Changing what's already on the site = included (an edit). Adding something that isn't there yet = quoted (a build). When a request crosses the line, the answer is never "no" — it's "love it, that's a small add-on, here's a quick quote." This turns scope creep into upsell revenue instead of free labor.

3. The Edit-Request Workflow (near-zero effort for Nate)

This is the engine of the plan. The whole point is that a client request flows in, gets executed by AI, redeploys itself, and gets confirmed back — with Nate doing little more than glancing at it. Here is the exact pipeline:

Step	What happens	Who does it
1. Request comes in	Client texts or emails a single dedicated address (e.g. edits@peak11media.com). At onboarding they're told: "Any change you want, just send it to this one address." Plain English is fine — "change my hours to 8-6" or "swap the homepage photo for this one."	Client
2. Triage	Request is read and classified instantly: (a) Included edit → do it. (b) Out-of-scope build → send a quick quote. (c) Needs clarification → one reply to confirm. Photos/files arrive as attachments.	Claude/AI
3. Execute the edit	For an included edit, Claude locates the file in the client's repo, makes the change, and redeploys via the gh api workflow (blob → tree → commit → update ref). Vercel/Netlify auto-deploys on push. Most text/photo edits take minutes.	Claude/AI
4. Verify	Claude confirms the change is live on the real site (loads the URL, checks the edit rendered, checks mobile). Nothing is reported done until it's confirmed live.	Claude/AI
5. Confirm to client	A short reply to the same thread: "Done — your hours now show 8-6, live on your site. Anything else?" This visible responsiveness is what makes people keep paying.	Claude/AI

Nate's actual involvement: a glance, not a task.

Claude runs steps 2–5 autonomously. Nate's only role is optional oversight — a quick look at out-of-scope quotes before they go out, and a heads-up if something's unusual. The edit, the redeploy, the live-verify, and the client reply all happen without Nate touching a keyboard. That is what makes 100 clients manageable.

Turnaround SLA

- **Promise:** action within **1 business day**. **Reality:** most simple edits go live the same day, often within the hour.
- **Acknowledge fast even if you can't finish fast.** Every request gets a reply confirming it's received within the business day, even if the fix needs more time. Silence is the only thing that loses a client.
- **Out-of-scope requests** get a same-day quote, not a delay. Speed on quotes wins the add-on sale.

4. Uptime & Health Monitoring

"Uptime monitoring" is a headline benefit and costs essentially nothing to deliver. Sites built on Vercel/Netlify are already highly reliable; monitoring just means we catch the rare problem before the client does.

How sites are checked	What it does
UptimeRobot (free tier)	Free monitors check each client URL every 5 minutes. Alerts by email/SMS on any outage. The free tier covers 50 monitors — enough for the first 50 clients at \$0.
Scheduled curl health-check	A simple scheduled script curls each client URL on a cadence, expects HTTP 200, and flags anything else. Runs free, scales past UptimeRobot's free cap, and can check for the SSL cert expiring too.
Manual spot-check	During the monthly value touch (Section 6), each managed site is loaded once by hand and eyeballed on desktop + mobile. Catches visual issues a status code won't.

What happens on an outage

- **Detect:** monitor fires an alert the moment a site returns a non-200 or stops responding.
- **Diagnose:** Claude checks the hosting status page (is it a Vercel/Netlify-wide incident or just this site?), recent deploys (did an edit break it? roll back), and the domain/SSL (did a renewal lapse?).
- **Fix:** roll back the last deploy, re-deploy, renew the cert/domain, or wait out a platform-wide incident — whichever the diagnosis points to. Most "outages" are a bad deploy fixed by a one-line rollback.
- **Communicate:** for anything more than a momentary blip, proactively text the client: "Noticed your site had a hiccup this morning — already fixed, you're back up." Catching it **before they call you** is the single most loyalty-building moment in the whole plan.

Proactive beats reactive.

A client who never knew their site went down — because you fixed it and told them after — will never cancel. The cost of delivering this is near zero; the retention value is enormous. Always reach out first.

5. Billing — Stripe Subscription, Hands-Off

The \$49/mo runs as an automatic Stripe subscription so revenue collects itself. Set it up once at onboarding and it bills monthly without anyone lifting a finger.

- **Setup:** a Stripe subscription product at **\$49/mo**. Client enters their card via a Stripe-hosted link or invoice at onboarding (Claude can send the link). Card on file, auto-charged monthly, receipt emailed automatically.
- **Books their start date** from the day the site goes live, so the first month aligns with launch.

Failed payment / dunning

- **Let Stripe Smart Retries do the work:** enable automatic retries + dunning emails. Stripe re-attempts a failed card on an optimized schedule and emails the client to update it — fully automated.
- **Retry window:** Stripe retries over ~2 weeks. The site stays live during this grace period — never yank a paying-history client's site over one expired card.
- **Personal nudge on day 3–4:** if the auto-emails don't fix it, one friendly text: "Heads up — looks like your card on file expired, here's the link to update it." Most failures are expired cards, not churn.
- **If still unpaid after the full retry window:** Stripe marks the subscription unpaid. Pause active work (edits/monitoring), notify the client the plan is paused, and keep the site live a short while longer before any suspension. Aim to recover, not to punish.

If a client cancels

- **The site is theirs.** They paid for the build — it belongs to them. Cancellation only ends the management plan, not their ownership.
- **Offer transfer help, graciously.** Hand off the code repo, point the domain wherever they want, and provide their hosting/login details. A smooth, no-drama offboarding is the best win-back setup there is — people come back to someone who treated them well on the way out.
- **Always ask one question:** "Mind if I ask what prompted it?" The answer tells you whether it's price, a slow month, or something fixable — and often surfaces a save (downgrade, pause for a season, etc.).
- **Schedule a 60–90 day win-back touch** (Section 7). Many cancel to "save money," then realize their site went stale or broke without you.

6. Retention — The Monthly Value Touch

Churn is the only thing that kills recurring revenue. The defense is simple: **make the client see value every single month**. A managed site is mostly invisible when it's working — so we make the work visible.

The monthly value email (templated, automated)

- Once a month, every Care Plan client gets a short, friendly email that proves the plan is working. It takes minutes to generate per client because it's templated and the data is pulled automatically.
- **What's in it:** a one-line traffic/health stat ("Your site was up 100% this month and had ~X visitors"), confirmation everything's current ("SSL renewed, software updated"), and — the hook — a **free seasonal update offer**: "Want me to swap in a summer banner / update your hours for the holiday? Just say the word."
- The free seasonal update is the retention lever: it reminds them the plan is generous, gets them to engage, and keeps the site feeling fresh — all of which makes cancelling feel like a loss.

The retention principle: never let the plan feel invisible.

People cancel things they forgot they were paying for. The monthly value touch guarantees they remember exactly what \$49 buys — a live, secure, up-to-date site and a person who quietly takes care of it. Visible value beats low price every time.

Quarterly check-in

- Every quarter, a slightly deeper personal touch — a real check-in, not a template: "Anything changing in the business I should get on the site? New services, new hours, a promo coming up?"
- This surfaces edits (engagement = retention) and frequently surfaces **paid upsells** — a new page, a booking feature, a seasonal campaign — which grows revenue per client on top of the \$49 base.
- It also catches a quietly unhappy client before they churn. A check-in that ends in "actually, can you change X" is a saved subscription.

Reducing churn & win-back

- **Responsiveness is retention.** The fast edit turnaround (Section 3) is itself the best anti-churn tool — clients don't leave a service that just works.
- **Annual prepay option:** offer ~2 months free for paying a year up front (\$490/yr). Locks in a full year and eliminates 12 chances to churn.
- **Win-back:** for cancelled clients, a no-pressure note at 60–90 days — "How's the site holding up? Door's open anytime if you want me back on it." Sites decay without management; many come back.

7. Scaling to Many Clients (keeping it passive)

The whole model only works if effort stays roughly flat as clients multiply. It does — because the work is templated, batched, AI-executed, and eventually delegable.

Lever	How it keeps load flat as clients grow
Templated edits	The same handful of requests recur across every client — hours, photos, prices, seasonal banners. Each has a known, fast playbook. The 10th "change my hours" takes the same minutes as the 1st.
AI execution	Claude does the edit + gh-api redeploy + live-verify. Adding a client adds almost no human time — the marginal cost of one more managed site is near zero.
Batching	Monthly value emails and health-checks run as a batch across all clients at once, not one-by-one. 100 clients = one batch job, not 100 errands.
Free monitoring	UptimeRobot free tier + scheduled curl scale to many sites at \$0. No per-client tooling cost eating the margin.
VA handoff (later)	Once volume justifies it, a part-time VA handles intake, simple edits, and the monthly touches off documented playbooks (this SOP). Nate/Claude keep oversight + complex work. This is the lever that lets the base grow past what one person could touch.

The scaling ladder

- **0–50 clients:** Claude runs everything; free monitoring covers it; Nate glances at quotes. Effort: a few hours/week. MRR up to ~\$2,450/mo.
- **50–100 clients:** move monitoring to the scheduled curl check (past UptimeRobot's free cap), keep edits AI-executed and batched. Still near-passive. MRR toward \$4,900/mo.

- **100+ clients:** bring in a VA on documented playbooks for intake + simple edits. Effort per client keeps falling; MRR keeps climbing. This is the passive-income flywheel fully spun up.

Flat effort, rising revenue — that's the whole game.

Every other part of Peak 11 (lead-gen, sales, builds) is linear: more revenue needs more work. The Care Plan is the only part that compounds. Protect it: deliver fast, keep the value visible, never let scope creep eat the margin, and the \$49/mo base becomes the most valuable asset the business owns.

Peak 11 Media — internal SOP. The build is the sale; the Care Plan is the business. Run this system and a steadily growing base of \$49/mo clients turns into recurring, near-passive monthly income.